

MERAKI WELLNESS - MEDICATION CONTRAINDICATION REFERENCE													
🔍 SEARCH: Press Ctrl+F (Windows) or Cmd+F (Mac)													
Medication Name (Brand)	Generic Name	Alternative Names (EU/UK/USA)	Primary Use/ Indication	Facial Treatments	Body Treatments	Massage Therapy	Pedicure	Manicure	Barber/ Hairstylist	Fitness/ Gym	Precautions	Contraindications	Notes
===== BLOOD THINNERS =====													
Warfarin	Warfarin	Coumadin (USA), Marevan (UK), Warfant (EU)	Blood thinner, prevent blood clots	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ MODERATE	Increased bruising risk, avoid aggressive treatments	No microdermabrasion, deep tissue massage, cuticle cutting	Allow extra healing time
Xarelto	Rivaroxaban	Xarelto (USA/UK/EU)	Prevent blood clots, stroke prevention	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ MODERATE	Increased bleeding risk	Avoid extractions, deep exfoliation, aggressive massage	24hr notice before intensive treatments
Eliquis	Apixaban	Eliquis (USA/UK/EU)	Blood clot prevention	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ MODERATE	Bleeding and bruising risk	No aggressive exfoliation or extraction	Gentle pressure only
Plavix	Clopidogrel	Plavix (USA/UK), Iscover (EU)	Prevent heart attack/stroke	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	⚠️ MODERATE	Platelet inhibitor, bleeding risk	Avoid waxing, extractions, deep massage	Gentle treatments recommended
Aspirin	Acetylsalicylic Acid	Aspirin, Bayer (USA/UK/EU)	Pain relief, blood thinner	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	Bleeding risk	Avoid waxing, extractions	Bruising may occur
===== ACNE MEDICATIONS =====													
Accutane	Isotretinoin	Roaccutane (UK/EU), Amnesteem, Claravis (USA)	Severe acne treatment	🚫 CONTRAINDICATED	🚫 CONTRAINDICATED	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	Extreme skin sensitivity, thinning	No waxing, peels, microdermabrasion, laser treatments	Wait 6-12 months post-treatment
Retin-A	Tretinoin	Retin-A (USA), Retacnyl (EU), Retino-A (UK)	Acne, anti-aging	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Increased photosensitivity, skin thinning	Avoid exfoliating treatments, waxing on treated areas	Stop 3-7 days before facial treatments
Differin	Adapalene	Differin (USA/UK/EU)	Acne treatment	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Skin sensitivity, dryness	Avoid chemical peels, aggressive exfoliation	Pause 2-3 days before treatments
===== DIABETES MEDICATIONS =====													
Metformin	Metformin	Glucophage (USA/UK/EU), Fortamet (USA)	Type 2 diabetes	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	Monitor blood sugar during exercise	Check for neuropathy in feet	May need snack during long sessions
Ozempic	Semaglutide	Ozempic, Wegovy (USA/UK/EU)	Type 2 diabetes, weight loss	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	Nausea, low blood sugar risk	Monitor during intensive fitness	Hydration essential
Insulin	Insulin (various)	Humalog, Novolog, Lantus (USA/UK/EU)	Diabetes management	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ MODERATE	Hypoglycemia risk during exercise	Check blood sugar before/after fitness	Have fast-acting carbs available
===== ANTIBIOTICS =====													
Doxycycline	Doxycycline	Vibramycin (USA), Efracea (UK/EU)	Bacterial infections, acne	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Photosensitivity	Avoid UV exposure, sun treatments	Use high SPF protection
Tetracycline	Tetracycline	Sumycin (USA), Tetracyn (UK/EU)	Bacterial infections, acne	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Sun sensitivity	No sun exposure treatments	Avoid LED/light therapy
===== CORTICOSTEROIDS =====													
Prednisone	Prednisone	Deltasone (USA), Prednisolone (UK/EU)	Anti-inflammatory, immune suppression	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	⚠️ MODERATE	Skin thinning, slow healing, infection risk	Gentle treatments only, monitor for bruising	Increased infection risk
Cortisone	Hydrocortisone	Cortef (USA), Efcortesol (UK), Hydrocortison (EU)	Anti-inflammatory	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	Skin fragility	Avoid aggressive treatments	Allow extra healing time
===== BLOOD PRESSURE MEDICATIONS =====													
Lisinopril	Lisinopril	Prinivil, Zestril (USA/UK/EU)	High blood pressure	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	May cause dizziness	Monitor blood pressure during exercise	Slow position changes in massage
Amlodipine	Amlodipine	Norvasc (USA/UK/EU)	High blood pressure, angina	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	May cause swelling in extremities	Gentle pressure on swollen areas	Elevate legs if needed
Losartan	Losartan	Cozaar (USA/UK/EU)	High blood pressure	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	May cause dizziness	Monitor during position changes	Ensure proper hydration

===== ANTIDEPRESSANTS =====													
Prozac	Fluoxetine	Prozac (USA/UK), Fluctin (EU)	Depression, anxiety	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	May affect mood, relaxation response	Massage can enhance benefits	Calming treatments recommended
Zoloft	Sertraline	Zoloft (USA/UK), Lustral (UK/EU)	Depression, anxiety, OCD	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	Relaxation therapies beneficial	Stress-reducing treatments helpful	May enhance treatment effects
Lexapro	Escitalopram	Lexapro (USA), Cipralex (UK/EU)	Depression, anxiety	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	Well tolerated	Spa treatments can complement therapy	Promote relaxation
===== THYROID MEDICATIONS =====													
Synthroid	Levothyroxine	Synthroid, Levoxyl (USA), Eltroxin (UK/EU)	Hypothyroidism	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Hair may be brittle	Gentle hair treatments	Deep conditioning beneficial
Levothyroxine	Levothyroxine	Levothroid (USA), Levothyroxine (UK/EU)	Thyroid hormone replacement	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Monitor energy levels	Treatments generally safe	Normal precautions
===== CHEMOTHERAPY AGENTS =====													
Methotrexate	Methotrexate	Trexall (USA), Maxtrex (UK/EU)	Cancer, autoimmune diseases	⚠️ CONTRAINDICATED	⚠️ CONTRAINDICATED	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CONTRAINDICATED	Severe immunosuppression, extreme sensitivity	No waxing, peels, or aggressive treatments	Medical clearance required
Tamoxifen	Tamoxifen	Nolvadex (USA/UK/EU)	Breast cancer treatment	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	Skin sensitivity, blood clot risk	Gentle treatments, monitor for swelling	Lymphatic drainage beneficial with approval
===== CHOLESTEROL MEDICATIONS =====													
Lipitor	Atorvastatin	Lipitor (USA/UK/EU)	High cholesterol	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	Muscle pain possible	Monitor for muscle soreness in massage	Reduce pressure if muscle pain present
Crestor	Rosuvastatin	Crestor (USA/UK/EU)	High cholesterol	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	Muscle weakness possible	Gentle massage pressure	Check for muscle pain
Zocor	Simvastatin	Zocor (USA/UK/EU)	High cholesterol	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	Muscle myopathy risk	Avoid deep tissue if muscle pain	Light to moderate pressure
===== OSTEOPOROSIS MEDICATIONS =====													
Fosamax	Alendronate	Fosamax (USA/UK/EU)	Osteoporosis	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ MODERATE	Bone fragility, jaw issues	Gentle pressure massage	Avoid high-impact exercises
Boniva	Ibandronate	Boniva (USA/UK/EU)	Osteoporosis	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠️ MODERATE	Bone health concerns	Careful with pressure points	Low-impact fitness recommended
===== IMMUNOSUPPRESSANTS =====													
Humira	Adalimumab	Humira (USA/UK/EU)	Autoimmune diseases	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	Infection risk, slow healing	Strict hygiene protocols	Monitor for any infections
Enbrel	Etanercept	Enbrel (USA/UK/EU)	Rheumatoid arthritis	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ MODERATE	Immunosuppression	Enhanced sanitation required	Gentle treatments only
===== PAIN MEDICATIONS =====													
Ibuprofen	Ibuprofen	Advil, Motrin (USA), Nurofen (UK/EU)	Pain, inflammation	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Mild blood thinning	May increase bruising slightly	Generally well tolerated
Naproxen	Naproxen	Aleve (USA), Naprosyn (USA/UK/EU)	Pain, inflammation	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Anti-inflammatory	Minor bruising risk	Standard precautions
===== HORMONE THERAPY =====													
Estrogen	Estradiol	Premarin (USA), Elleste (UK), Estradot (EU)	Hormone replacement	⚠️ CAUTION	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	May affect skin sensitivity	Monitor for skin changes	Adjust treatments as needed
Testosterone	Testosterone	AndroGel (USA), Testogel (UK/EU)	Hormone replacement	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	May increase oil production	Adjust facial treatments for oil	Deep cleaning beneficial
Birth Control	Ethinyl Estradiol/Levonorgestrel	Yasmin, Ortho Tri-Cyclen (USA), Microgynon (UK/EU)	Contraception, hormone regulation	⚠️ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	May cause melasma, sensitivity	Avoid sun treatments, use SPF	Monitor for pigmentation

===== ANTIPSYCHOTICS =====													
Abilify	Aripiprazole	Abilify (USA/UK/EU)	Schizophrenia, bipolar	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Calming environment beneficial	Relaxation treatments helpful	Quiet, peaceful setting
Seroquel	Quetiapine	Seroquel (USA/UK/EU)	Bipolar, schizophrenia	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	May cause sedation	Gentle, relaxing treatments	Monitor energy levels
===== ANTIHISTAMINES =====													
Zyrtec	Cetirizine	Zyrtec (USA/UK/EU)	Allergies	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	May cause drowsiness	Normal treatments	Well tolerated
Claritin	Loratadine	Claritin (USA/UK/EU)	Allergies	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Non-sedating	No restrictions	Safe for all treatments
Benadryl	Diphenhydramine	Benadryl (USA/UK/EU)	Allergies, sleep	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Sedation	May enhance relaxation	Ensure client alertness post-treatment
===== MIGRAINE MEDICATIONS =====													
Imitrex	Sumatriptan	Imitrex (USA), Imigran (UK/EU)	Migraine treatment	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Quiet environment beneficial	Cranial massage helpful	Dim lighting, aromatherapy
Botox	OnabotulinumtoxinA	Botox (USA/UK/EU)	Migraines, cosmetic	⚠ MODERATE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Recent injection sites sensitive	No facial massage 24-48hrs post-injection	Avoid laying flat 4hrs post-treatment
===== ASTHMA MEDICATIONS =====													
Albuterol	Albuterol/Salbutamol	ProAir, Ventolin (USA), Salamol (UK/EU)	Asthma, bronchospasm	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ MODERATE	Have inhaler accessible	Monitor breathing during exercise	Reduce intensity if needed
Advair	Fluticasone/Salmeterol	Advair (USA), Seretide (UK/EU)	Asthma, COPD	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ MODERATE	Respiratory precautions	Ensure good ventilation	Have rescue inhaler available
===== DIURETICS =====													
Lasix	Furosemide	Lasix (USA/UK/EU)	Fluid retention, hypertension	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Dehydration risk, electrolyte imbalance	Ensure proper hydration	Bathroom access needed
HCTZ	Hydrochlorothiazide	Microzide (USA), HydroSaluric (EU)	High blood pressure, edema	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Photosensitivity, dehydration	Hydration essential, avoid sun treatments	Monitor for dizziness
===== ANTIFUNGALS =====													
Lamisil	Terbinafine	Lamisil (USA/UK/EU)	Fungal infections	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	⚠ CAUTION	SAFE	SAFE	Treating active infection	Enhanced sanitation protocols	May continue treatments with precautions
Diflucan	Fluconazole	Diflucan (USA/UK/EU)	Fungal infections	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	Systemic antifungal	Normal treatments	No special restrictions
===== MUSCLE RELAXANTS =====													
Flexeril	Cyclobenzaprine	Flexeril, Amrix (USA), Flexiban (EU)	Muscle spasms	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Sedation, dizziness	Massage enhances muscle relaxation	Monitor for excessive drowsiness
Skelaxin	Metaxalone	Skelaxin (USA/UK/EU)	Muscle pain and spasms	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Sedative effects	Therapeutic massage beneficial	Ensure client alertness
===== COGNITIVE DISORDER MEDICATIONS =====													
Aricept	Donepezil	Aricept (USA/UK/EU)	Alzheimer's disease	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	May need assistance, memory issues	Calming, familiar environment	Clear communication, patience
Namenda	Memantine	Namenda (USA), Ebixa (UK/EU)	Alzheimer's disease	SAFE	SAFE	✓ BENEFICIAL	SAFE	SAFE	SAFE	⚠ CAUTION	Cognitive impairment	Gentle, repetitive explanations	Supervised treatments